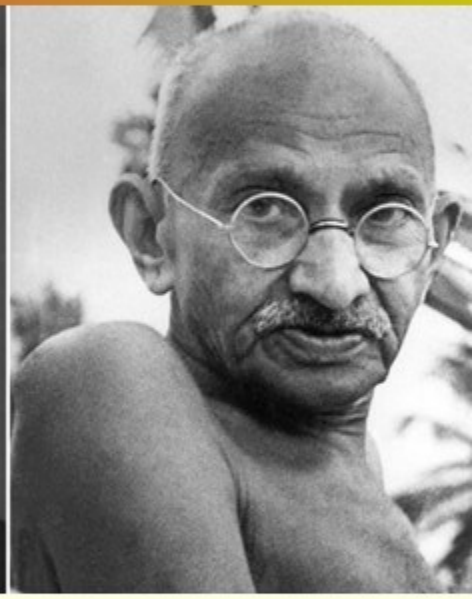


MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

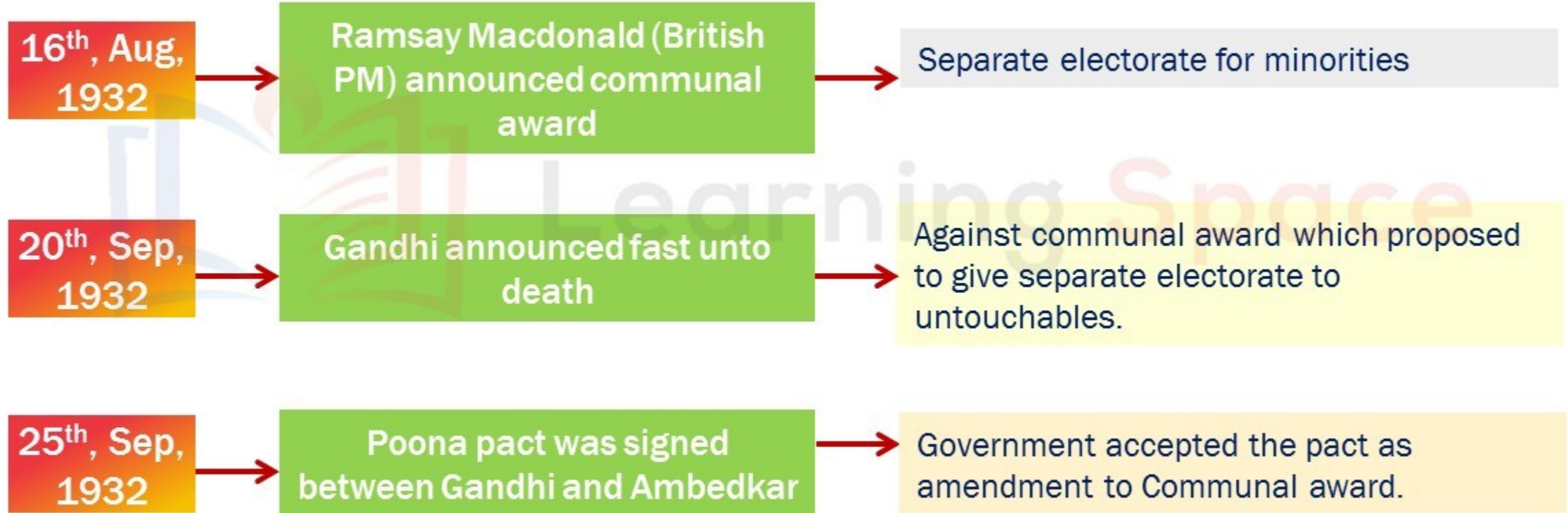


MODULE - 39

EVENTS BETWEEN (1928-1935)
COMMUNAL AWARD

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

COMMUNAL AWARD



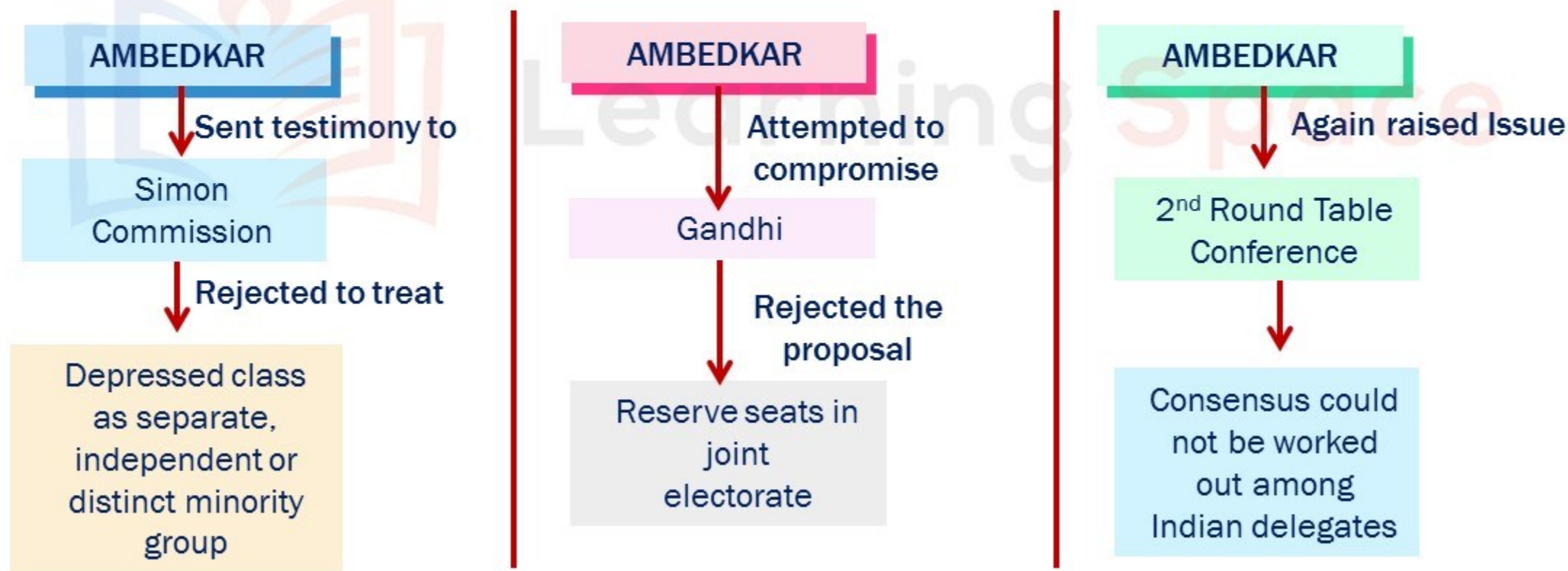
In summary, by communal award, the British were successful in diverting attention from Civil Disobedience Movement and created a dissension among the Hindus.

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

COMMUNAL AWARD -1932

BACKGROUND

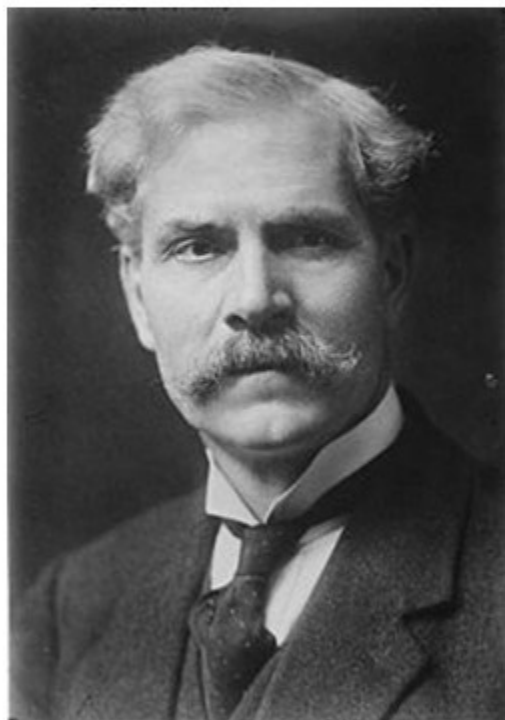
Ambedkar has been persistently demanding protection for the depressed classes which finally came true with the announcement of Communal award in 1932.



EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

COMMUNAL AWARD -1932

It was **based on old British policy of divide and rule**. Earlier, they divided Hindus and Muslims and now they wanted to divide the caste Hindus and depressed Classes



BRITISH PM RAMSAY MACDONALD

After the 2nd RTC Government were of the view that Goodwill of the Congress was not required, but the confidence of those who supported the British against the Congress government functionaries, loyalists, etc.—was very essential.



So, British PM Ramsay MacDonald on 16th Aug. 1932 announced controversial communal award for Minorities also known as MacDonald award or communal award.



Award announced, like that of Muslims, other communities like **Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians, depressed classes** are also a minority group thus entitled for **separate electorate** as pressed by B.R.Ambedkar

The implicit objective of communal award was to **strike down nationalism** and create parochial royalties towards communities.

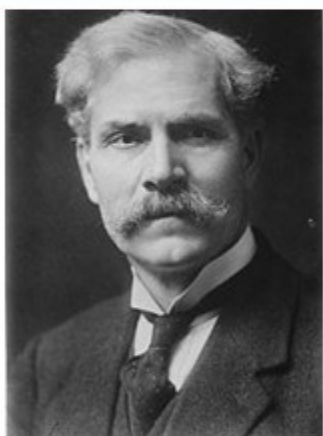
EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

COMMUNAL AWARD -1932

Communal Award

↓ *Based on
findings of*

Lothian Committee
(Indian Franchise Committee)



RAMSAY MACDONALD

Separate electorate
and reserved seats
for minorities

Doubled the existing seats in provincial legislature

Retain the system of separate electorate for minorities

Depressed classes are recognized as minority community and entitled for separate electorate

Grant weightage for Muslims in provinces they were in minority

Reserve 7 seats for Marathas

3% seats reserved for women in all provincial legislature except NWFP

SEPARATE
ELECTORATE

Europeans, Sikhs, Indian Christians,
Muslims Anglo-Indians, depressed classes
even Marathas for some seats in Bombay

RESERVED SEATS

Labour, Landlords, traders and industrialists

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

COMMUNAL AWARD -1932

Separate electorate were opposed by Nationalist

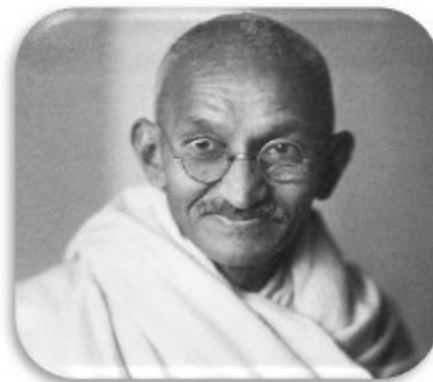
CONGRESS

Saw this as
manifestation of British
Divide and rule policy
by treating depressed
class a separate
minority political entity



GANDHI

- ✓ Saw it as “Attack on Hindu unity and nationalism”
- ✓ Once they are declared as separate political entity, Untouchability would be institutionalized, question of abolishing untouchability will be undermined and can never be removed from society.
- ✓ “Untouchables remained untouchable in perpetuity”. What is required is not protection but, eradication of untouchability.



Fast unto death to press his demands of
Joint electorate, expressing no objection
for giving large number of reserved seats

EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

POONA PACT 1932

20th, Sep,
1932

GANDHI OBSERVED FAST UNTO
DEATH

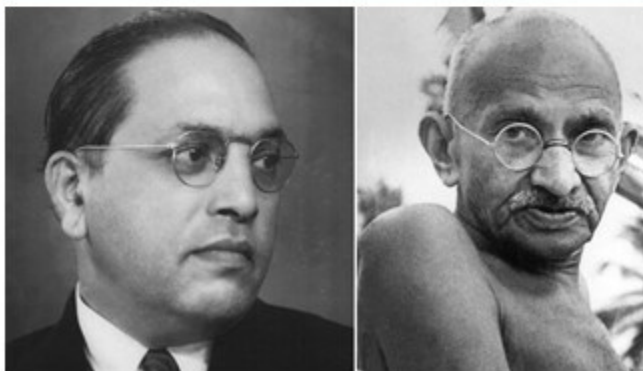
The day was observed as day of fasting and prayer, temples, wells etc. were thrown open to the depressed classes.

Congress leaders approached Dr. Ambedkar (the proponent of separate electorate for depressed class) to negotiate on the matter.

25th, Sep,
1932

PACT BETWEEN GANDHI AND
AMBEDKAR WAS SIGNED,
ALSO CALLED AS POONA PACT.

Via this pact, Ambedkar agreed on Joint Electorates while Gandhi agreed for reservation of seats (double in number than existing in provincial legislature) for depressed classes in provincial legislatures and adequate representation of Dalits in civil services.



EVENTS DURING (1928 - 1935)

POONA PACT 1932

Amidst MacDonald promised to accept any alternative scheme mutually agreed upon by Hindus and Depressed classes. The Poona pact was **accepted by the government as a amendment to the communal award.**



The terms of the pact include

Principle of joint electorate is accepted

148 seats in different provincial legislature were reserved for depressed classes in place of 71 as provided in the communal award

18% seats in central legislature were reserved for the depressed classes

Adequate representation will be given to the depressed classes in civil services

EVENTS DURING (1930 - 1934)

Despite giving certain political rights to the depressed classes, it could not achieve the desired goal of emancipation of the depressed class. It enabled the same old Hindu social order to continue and gave birth to many problems.

JOINT ELECTORATES

Gave birth to many problems

Deprived the right of Dalit to send true and effective representative to legislature

Made the committee leaderless

Gave Hindu majority the virtual right to nominate the member of deprived class who are prepared to be tools of Hindu majority

Depressed classes now have to submit to status-quo in political, dialogical and cultural fields

Denied separate and distinct existence for the community

Which was given later by constitution of Independent India

Poona Pact perhaps put obstructions in the way of an ideal society based on equality, liberty, fraternity and justice.

MODERN HISTORY

GANDHI'S HARIJAN CAMPAIGN

To undo

Government divide and rule policy

Started from

YERAVADA JAIL

↓ Sep 1932

All India-Anti
Untouchability
League(AIAUL)- HSK

Jan 1933

Harijan weekly

↓ May 1933

“Purification fast” for
21 days

AFTER RELEASE

↓ Aug 1933

Shifted from
**SABARMATI
ASHRAM**

To

**SATYAGRAHA
ASHRAM
(WARDHA)**

Vowed not to return unless swaraj was won

HARIJAN TOUR

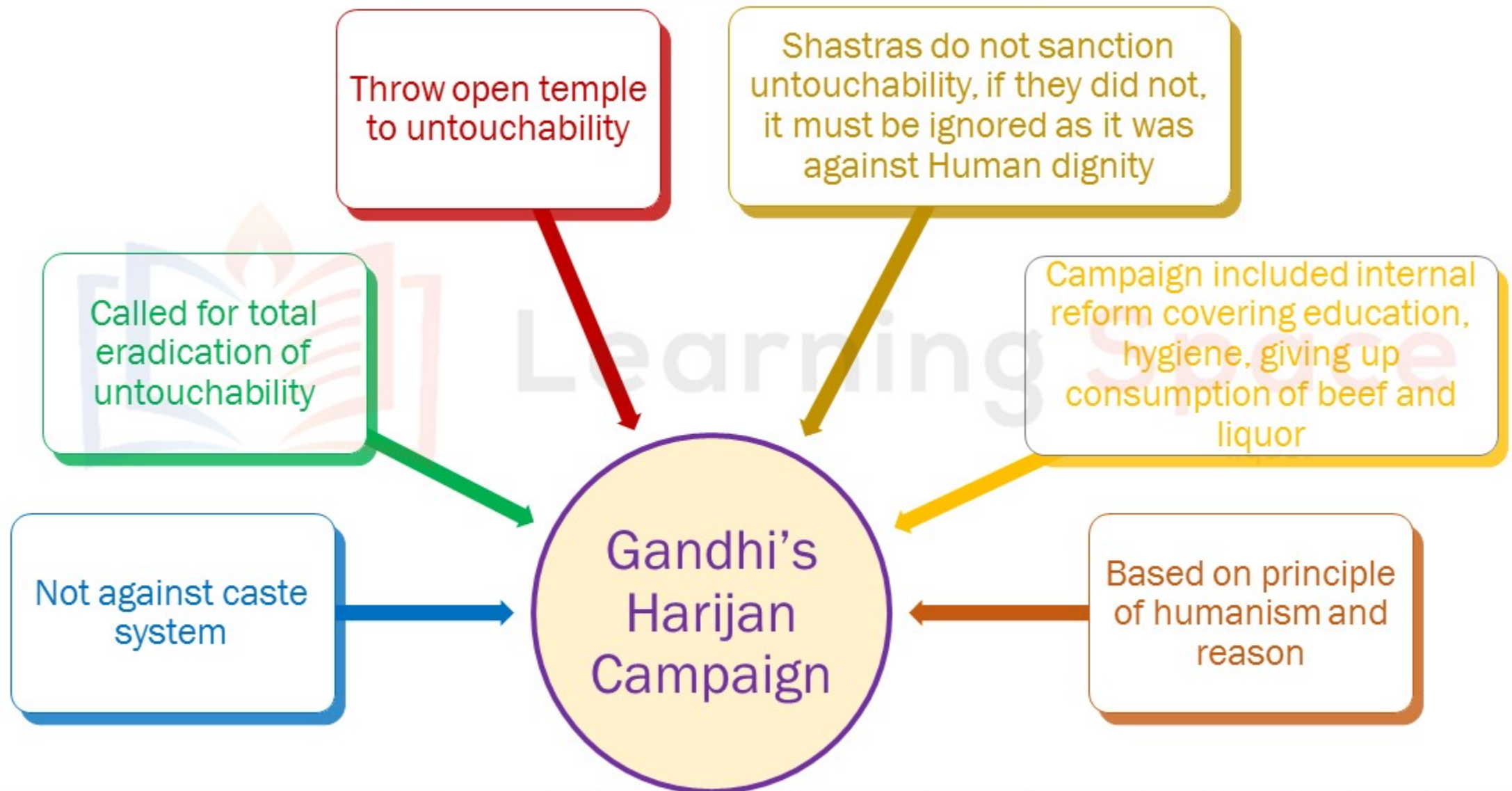
- Collecting Money for Harijan Sevak Sangh
- Propagating removal of untouchability
- Urged political workers to go to villages for socio-Economic Political upliftment of Harijans

2 FASTS

To convince the
followers
seriousness of
their effort



GANDHI'S HARIJAN CAMPAIGN



In Oct 1934, Gandhi decided to **withdraw himself from active politics to devote all his time to the cause of Harijan**

EVENTS DURING (1930 - 1934)

GANDHI'S HARIJAN CAMPAIGN



Harijan Sevak Sangh

(FOUNDED BY MAHATMA GANDHI IN 1932)

HARIJAN SEVAK SANGH

All India Anti Untouchability League, to remove untouchability in the society, which later renamed as Harijan Sevak Sangh ("Servants of Untouchables Society")

Industrialist **Ghanshyam Das Birla** was its founding president with Amritlal Takkar as its Secretary.

Sangh **helped the depressed classes to access public places** such as temples, schools, roads and water resources, also conducted inter dining and inter caste marriages.

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